PG Basic Licence — Requirements and Documents

Apex Adventures (Paramotor SA (Pty) Ltd, SACAA DTO 0012) · Paragliding (PG) only · Compiled 26 Oct 2026 from CAR Part 62 Subpart 8, SA-CATS 62 Appendices R62.35 / R62.37, the SAHPA Training and Procedures Manual (TPM) and SAHPA's 2025 forms.

1. Who this is for

New paragliding students who want a **PG Basic licence**, the first licence that lets you fly solo without an instructor at Basic-graded sites. Your Grade A or B instructor signs you off; SAHPA and SACAA issue the licence.

2. Before you start training

- Minimum age 14 for the National Pilot Learner's Certificate (student licence) and 16 for the National Pilot Licence
- Able to speak, read and write English fluently
- Medical fitness declaration (SAHPA Medical Fitness form)
- Register with SAHPA as a student and submit a copy of your ID or passport before any flight is logged; registration must reach SAHPA within 3 days of starting
- Theory exam passed, then the skills test. The skills test must be flown within 90 days of passing the theory exam and within 60 days before you apply (CAR 62.08.5)

3. Experience requirements

Requirement	SACAA minimum (SA-CATS R62.35)	SAHPA TPM standard
Flights	35 high flights of at least 60 seconds each	35 flights of at least 60 seconds each (10 on PG if you are already a PPG pilot)
Airtime	At least 4 hours	At least 4 hours solo
Height	Flights over 50 m above ground level	20 solo flights from over 100 m height difference
Sites	At least 2 flying sites	At least 2 different mountain sites
Soaring	Not set	At least one solo soaring flight of 20 minutes or more
Thermals	Not set	2 solo flights of 10 minutes or more in light thermals, each with thermalling turns (consecutive 360s in rising air)

Requirement	SACAA minimum (SA-CATS R62.35)	SAHPA TPM standard
Tandem flights	Not set	At most 5 passenger flights on an instructor's tandem, each at least 5 minutes, count towards the 35
Winch-trained pilots	At least 5 mountain flights over at least 2 days	At least 5 solo flights from a mountain site of 100 m or more height difference over at least 2 days, including ridge soaring with other pilots
Logbook	Instructor signs every flight	Instructor signs on a daily basis

Where the two columns differ, follow the higher figure and confirm with your instructor.

4. Theory exam

- Basic licence exam, **pass mark 85%** (SA-CATS R62.37)
- Subjects: General, Airflow, Aerodynamics, Flight Control, Air Rules, Common Sense, Airmanship

5. Practical / skills test

All tasks in SA-CATS-FCL 62.08.5.1, including (SAHPA TPM):

- Good layout and pre-flight checks, including the 5-point check
- Unassisted forward and reverse pull-ups, inflation and ground control; holding the canopy overhead in enough wind
- At least 10 good unassisted forward take-offs in 0 to 10 km/h wind, and at least 10 forward and 10 reverse pull-up take-offs (cross-brake method, no swapping or letting go of toggles)
- S-turns or figure 8s, and 90 and 180 degree turns left and right
- 360 degree turns left and right
- Landing approach set-up, and 3 out of 3 landings in a 50 m circle
- Big ears with and without speedbar, speedbar use, and flight and landing on the rear risers, with the dangers explained
- Parachute-landing-roll technique and knowledge of reserve deployment

- Experience of flying with several pilots sharing a ridge
- Assess launch conditions: weather, field, wing weight range and rating

No student training flights or ground handling in winds above 24 km/h, or when the gust variance is above 10 km/h.

6. Documents to submit

#	Document	Notes
1	SAHPA membership application form	Completed and signed by the pilot and a Grade A or B instructor
2	Medical Fitness form	Per SA-CATS
3	Marked and passed Basic licence exam	85% or higher
4	Training Proficiency Card	Completed and signed
5	Practical Requirements Card	Completed and signed
6	Basic Licence Theory Checklist	Completed and signed
7	Logbook copy	Signed by a Grade A or B instructor
8	CA 62.16 application form	From SAHPA Forms & Checklists. Flights and hours must match your logbook
9	CA 62.15 skills test form	Completed and signed after the skills test
10	CA 183-540 consent form	Signed
11	Certified copy of ID or passport, and 2 colour ID photographs	Follow SAHPA's ID & Passport Specifications sheet
12	Membership and licence fees with proof of payment	Current SAHPA fee schedule

7. Steps

1. Register as a student with SAHPA before your first flight.
2. Train with a SAHPA-rated instructor and log every flight.

3. Pass the Basic theory exam (85%).
4. Fly the skills test within 90 days of the exam.
5. Your instructor signs the cards, checklist and logbook.
6. Submit the documents above to SAHPA within 60 days of the skills test.
7. SAHPA submits to SACAA; upload your SACAA licence in the Flight Hub when it is issued.

8. Source notes

- CAR Part 62 Subpart 8; SA-CATS 62 Appendices R62.35 (item 1(i)) and R62.37; SAHPA TPM Part 5 (5.2, 5.3, 5.8.1 and 5.8.2); SAHPA Forms & Checklists page (2025 packs).
- Part 106 (Hang-gliding and Paragliding) was published as a draft for comment in May 2022; its final status was not confirmed. A SAHPA member's 2021 analysis says the draft drops the minimum of 7 days' training for Basic.
- SA-CATS 62 Appendix R62.38 (skills test requirements) was not read in full.